

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

THURSDAY, AUGUST 21, 2025

Concession workers say they lose with AI



COURTESY OF TD GARDEN

In 2021, TD Garden collaborated with Amazon to bring two fully cashier-less stores to the arena.

Cite loss of tips and hours at Fenway and TD Garden

By Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Amanda Savage works as a floater at Fenway Park, going where she's needed to serve hungry and thirsty fans. At concession stands, she'll work with as many as seven other people, chatting with customers as she hands them hot dogs, snacks, and drinks and offering a thank you when they drop a buck or two in the tip jar.

But increasingly, she's assigned to troubleshoot at AI-powered self-checkouts, where customers show their food and drinks to cameras, get the bill, pay it, and get back to the game. Her only co-workers are the machines, which generate no conversation, connection, or tips.

"I hear people say, 'Who am I tipping now? I did all the work myself,'" said Savage, who estimates her tip income falls by half when she is assigned to the kiosks.

What's happening at Fenway shows how artificial intelligence is starting to reshape the labor force. AI is not only reducing the number of people needed to handle certain tasks, but it's also

AI CHECKOUT, Page A10

Warren's latest jabs get rise out of Trump

Senator focuses on his promise to lower prices

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Just two months ago, President Trump and Senator Elizabeth Warren were having a rare kumbaya moment.

The longtime adversaries from opposite ends of the ideological spectrum declared they finally found something to agree on: eliminating the limit on the national debt. But the detente between two of America's most combative politicians didn't last long.

In recent weeks, Warren has pounded away at Trump for failing to fulfill his campaign promise to "immediately bring prices down, starting on Day One." Trump has responded by unleashing a fusillade of insults and false accusations against Warren that demonstrate her attacks might be working — and could provide a template for Democrats in next year's midterm elections.

On social media and in official appearances, Trump has called the Massachusetts Democrat "a liar," "a nut job," "a loser," and "a total lunatic" who should be "drug tested" after he falsely claimed she was "jumping up and down" during an event with New York City mayoral candidate Zohran Mamdani. He asserted without evidence she was responsible for putting "a lot" of Midwestern banks "out of business."

Through it all, he has revived a derogatory

WARREN, Page A7

Israel moves on West Bank, Gaza

Approval of settlements and military advances ignore international criticism

By Lara Jakes
NEW YORK TIMES

Israel on Wednesday approved new settlements in the West Bank and announced that it was moving ahead with plans to take over Gaza City, bucking international criticism and defying growing support for the creation of an independent Palestinian state.

The moves raised questions about whether a new cease-fire pro-

posal, which officials have said is similar to terms that Israel previously endorsed, could move forward.

Experts said the two moves suggested that Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu was bending to the ideologies of extremists in his coalition in order to remain in power — even at the cost of isolating Israel internationally.

The idea of a Palestinian state "is being erased from the table," Bezael

Smotrich, the hard-line finance minister, declared after the government approved a settlement project of 3,400 housing units in the heart of the occupied West Bank.

"Every town, every neighborhood, every housing unit is another nail in the coffin of this dangerous idea," Smotrich said Wednesday.

At the same time, the Israeli military said it was advancing plans to take over Gaza City, with troops already on the city's outskirts and tents being moved into the southern Gaza Strip for displaced people.

An additional 50,000 reservists

would be told to report for duty in September, while troops have already obtained "operational control" over 75 percent of the Gaza Strip, the military said in statements. The United Nations has put that number closer to 90 percent.

The military "has begun the next phase of the war," said Brigadier General Effie Defrin, the Israeli military's chief spokesperson.

The looming assault aims to prevent Hamas — which led the deadly Oct. 7, 2023, onslaught on southern Israel that started the war — from

GAZA, Page A5

CATCHING A WAVE



JOE BURBANK/ORLANDO SENTINEL VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

A fisherman walked on a pier as large waves generated by Hurricane Erin crashed into the jetty at Lighthouse Point Park in Ponce Inlet, Fla., on Wednesday. The storm was churning up menacing waves that have closed beaches from the Carolinas to New York City. In Massachusetts, Governor Maura Healey urged caution at local beaches. **B3.**

'How is this project wasteful in any way?'

DOMINIKA PARRY, founder of an environmental justice nonprofit that lost EPA funding

Cuts have some on edge in needy Miss.

State's reliance on federal aid may prove costly

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

JACKSON, Miss. — Near the end of West Capitol Street — past abandoned homes engulfed by greenery, ancient asphalt cracked at odd angles, and homeless people trudging

through sweltering summer heat — stands a deteriorating former school building that houses Voice of Calvary Ministries.

The faith-based organization that for 50 years has served low-income Jacksonians was slated for a long-overdue facelift and expansion, courtesy of a \$20 million Environmental Protection Agency grant. The planned "resilience hub" would have helped not just this downtrod-

den section of West Jackson but the whole state, during natural disasters and other crises, by adding an emergency shelter to the property complete with solar panels, a well, showers, and 150 beds.

Then, in March, the EPA terminated the grant "on the grounds that the award no longer effectuates the program goals or agency priorities."

Mississippi, a stronghold of

MISSISSIPPI, Page A10



PHOTOS BY JULIAN SORAPURU/GLOBE STAFF

Clockwise from left: Debris from March tornadoes was still on the ground in July in Walthall County, Miss. Stained glass windows at Voice of Calvary Ministries was marked by holes. An abandoned house in West Jackson was overgrown by bushes and trees.

At Kennedy School, a worry eases

Most foreign students are expected on campus

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

The Harvard Kennedy School expects the vast majority of its foreign students to be able to enter the US and study at its Cambridge campus this fall, administrators said Wednesday —

a welcome sign for the institution as American academia braces for widespread disruption to international enrollment.

More than half of the 1,000-student body at the Kennedy School comes from abroad, the highest proportion on campus. Given the threats by the Trump administration, Harvard had a backup plan to let its international students study outside the US if they were not allowed into the country, a program called HKS Global. But administrators say that now won't be necessary.

"At this time, there is not enough student demand to launch HKS Global," a spokesperson said. "The cohorts would be too small and the class offerings too few to ensure the world-class HKS experience that our students deserve."

It's too soon to tell whether the Kennedy School's experience will be typical. Some in academia have projected declines in international enrollment across the country to reach as high as 40 percent in coming years. That's due in large part to the fallout from President Trump's

HARVARD, Page A7

NATO defense chiefs held a "candid discussion" about what security guarantees they could offer Kyiv to help forge a peace agreement. **A3.**

The Republican-controlled Texas House of Representatives voted to approve a new congressional map creating five new potential GOP seats. **A2.**

Relatives and friends mourned Savanah Gatchell, the 13-year-old killed in a crash. The 16-year-old driver was charged with motor vehicle homicide. **B1.**

Stop & Shop promised price reductions on more than 3,000 items at stores throughout the region. **D1.**



Gray, gray, go away

Thursday: Cloudy, breezy. High: 66-71. Low: 57-62.

Friday: Windy, warmer. High: 74-79. Low: 61-66.

Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**

VOL. 308, NO. 52

Suggested retail price
\$4.00

